

Marriage and the Home

What God joins together He also instructs, and the instruction is heavier and kinder than the culture's.

Text. Selected texts on marriage and family

Good for. Married couples, single people, and parents under one roof

The arc. Marriage was God's design before sin and is His picture of Christ and the church after it. This series moves from the design to the covenant to the home it builds, refusing both the romance that promises too much and the cynicism that expects nothing.

1. One Flesh by Design

Genesis 2:18-25

Big idea. Marriage is God's idea, made to answer the first thing He called not good, and joined into one flesh by His hand.

Aim. To return the hearer's marriage to the ground God built it on.

Notes

2. A Profound Mystery

Ephesians 5:22-33

Big idea. Husbands and wives display the love between Christ and His church, which sets the bar at sacrifice, not mere affection.

Aim. To raise the hearer's marriage from a deal between two people to a picture of the gospel.

Notes

3. Love That Stays

1 Corinthians 13:1-13

Big idea. The love that holds a marriage is patient and kind and does not keep a record of wrongs, because it is the love God first showed us.

Aim. To replace the hearer's feeling of love with the practice of it.

Notes

4. Raising Children in the Lord

Deuteronomy 6:4-9

Big idea. Faith is handed down not in a program but in the ordinary talk of a home where God is loved out loud.

Aim. To make the hearer's home the first place their children hear the gospel.

Notes

5. Fathers, Children, and the Long Patience

Ephesians 6:1-4

Big idea. Children honor, and fathers raise without provoking, because the home is meant to school the heart in grace, not anger.

Aim. To soften the hearer's parenting into the patience of God toward them.

Notes

HOW TO USE THIS SERIES

These are starting points, not scripts. Each series gives you the arc, the divisions, and a working aim for every sermon, but the breakdown here is scaffolding you will take down once the text has done its own work in you. Read the whole book before you preach the first week of it. Let the passage divisions teach you where the seams actually are.

The text sets the agenda. Not the felt needs you arrived with, not the outline that looks clean on a slide, not the application you already know you want to land. Sit under the passage long enough for it to surprise you, and then preach what it says rather than what you planned. A big idea you did not have to fight for is usually one the text did not give you.